

PAI 748: Nonprofit Management

Spring Term, 2016

Thursdays, 9:30am – 12:15pm

Room 315, Maxwell Hall

Instructor: Jesse D. Lecy (jdlecy@syr.edu)

Office Hours: Monday 2:00pm – 3:00pm

Office #436, Crouse-Hinds Hall

Prerequisites: None

Course Description

The nonprofit sector is an integral part of the US economy and a vibrant part of American civic life. This course is meant to introduce students to the rich history of the sector and modern management challenges that nonprofits face. The course will cover theories that guide research on nonprofits, important themes in nonprofit governance and leadership, and some specific case studies of nonprofit sectors such as international development and the environmental movement. The course will give students a foundation for future employment in the sector.

Learning Objectives

Through the material covered in this course students will:

- Understand the primary theories pertaining to important activities in the nonprofit sector
- Develop a basic understanding of nonprofit governance, finances and policy
- Develop knowledge of substance differences between key nonprofit subsectors

Course Requirements and Grades

This is a survey course meant to expose students to topics in a broad field, and as such it is a course that emphasizes breadth more than depth. Students are expected to keep up with weekly readings. Semester activities will receive the following weights in the final grade:

Foundation Profile:	5%
S.E. Presentation:	5%
Grant Peer Evaluation:	5%
Peer Critiques:	5%
Interview/Reflection:	15%
Take-Home Exam:	15%
BYO NP Project:	40%

Class participation includes classroom discussion and contribution to course content through presentations and newspaper articles. Days that indicate news articles on the schedule require students to find a recent news story that pertains to the class topic for the day. Students will submit the article on Blackboard, along with two paragraphs on how it pertains to the readings for the day. In addition, please be prepared to discuss in class.

Students will work on a project building their own nonprofit throughout the semester. The deliverables (and their final proportional point value) will consist of the following:

- (1) Identify Three Benchmark NPs (5%)
- (2) Mission Statement and Program Logic Model (5%)
- (3) Revenue Growth Strategy (5%)
- (4) Governance Recommendations (5%)
- (5) A Grant LOI for a Local Foundation (20%)

The final interview consists of students identifying one person in the nonprofit sector that they wish to meet with to discuss a career in the nonprofit sector. Students report back during the final presentation on their findings and submit a paper with some reflections on what they have learned in the class.

This course uses plus-minus grading. Grades will be assigned as follows:

A	=	94-100
A-	=	90-94
B+	=	86-90
B	=	83-86
B-	=	80-83
C+	=	77-80
C	=	73-77
C-	=	70-73
D	=	60-69
F	=	0-59

Required Texts

There are no required texts for class this semester. All readings will be posted through BlackBoard or provided in class.

Recommended Texts:

Starting and Managing a Nonprofit Organization: A Legal Guide, Hopkins, 2013.

Diminished Democracy, Theda Skocpol, 2003

How Markets Fail, John Cassidy, 2009

Nonprofit Organizations: Theory, Management, Policy, Helmut Anheier, 2005 (1st Edition)

The State of Nonprofit America, Lester Salamon, 2012 (2nd Edition)

Starting and Building a Nonprofit, Peri Pakroo, 2013 (5th Edition)

Starting and Managing a NP Organization: A Legal Guide, Bruce Hopkins, 2013 (6th Edition)

Late assignment policy:

Late assignments will be docked one letter grade each day they are missing.

Course Schedule:

Class 01 (Jan 21) – Course Overview

No readings today. Watch The Lottery.

Class 02 (Jan 28) – Civil Society and Social Capital

Skocpol, T. (2013). Diminished democracy: From membership to management in American civic life (Vol. 8). University of Oklahoma press. CH2 & CH4.

Putnam, R. D. (1995). Tuning In, Tuning Out: The Strange Disappearance of Social Capital in America. *Political Science & Politics*, 28(04), 664-683.

Bishop, B. (2009). The Big Sort: Why the clustering of like-minded America is tearing us apart. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt. pp 141-155, 221-228.

Rich, M. “Nation’s Wealthy Poor Money into Public Schools.” *The New York Times*: Oct 21, 2014.

Supplementary Readings:

Nelson, A. A., & Gazley, B. (2014). The Rise of School-Supporting Nonprofits. *Education Finance and Policy*.

Murray, C. (2013). *Coming Apart: The State of White America, 1960-2010*. Random House LLC.

Isserman, A. M., Feser, E., & Warren, D. E. (2009). Why some rural places prosper and others do not. *International regional science review*, 32(3), 300-342.

DUE: Select your Build-Your-Own Nonprofit project.

Class 03 (Feb 4) – The Legal and Historic Foundations of the Sector

Hall, P. D. (2006). A historical overview of philanthropy, voluntary associations, and nonprofit organizations in the United States, 1600-2000. *The Nonprofit Sector: A Research Handbook* (W. Powell & R. Steinberg eds., Yale University Press 2d ed.), 32-65.

Incorporating a Social Enterprise: a Simple Legal Guide, engageSpark.

Supplementary Readings:

Sansing, R., & Yetman, R. (2006). Governing private foundations using the tax law. *Journal of Accounting and Economics*, 41(3), 363-384.

The Legal Framework for Nonprofit Organizations, in *The Nonprofit Sector: A Research Handbook* (W. Powell & R. Steinberg eds., Yale University Press 2d ed., 2006), 243-266.

Moore, D., & Connolly Heldge, T. (2012). *Overview of Nonprofit Organizations: The Basic Framework*.

DUE: Step 1 – Identify Three Benchmark Nonprofits.

Discuss: Theory of Change and Logic Models

Class 04 (Feb 11) – Theoretical Foundation of the Nonprofit Sector

Anheier, H. K. (2014). *Nonprofit organizations: Theory, management, policy*. Routledge. CH8 – Theories of Nonprofit Organizations.

Young, D. R. (2000). Alternative models of government-nonprofit sector relations: theoretical and international perspectives. *Nonprofit and voluntary sector quarterly*, 29(1), 149-172.

Phills, J., Denend, L. (2005). *Social Entrepreneurs Correcting Market Failures*. Stanford Business School, Case No: SI72 B.

Supplementary Readings:

Cassidy, J. (2009). *How markets fail: The logic of economic calamities*. Macmillan. CH9-CH12.

Smith & Lipsky, “The Political Economy of Nonprofit Revenues.” In: Hammack, D. C. (Ed.). (2000). *Making the nonprofit sector in the United States: A reader*. Indiana University Press.

Anheier, H. K. (2014). *Nonprofit organizations: Theory, management, policy*. Routledge. CH16 – State-Nonprofit Relations.

Milward, H. B. (1994). *Nonprofit contracting and the hollow state*.

<http://www.c-span.org/video/?298300-6/government-funding-nonprofits>

Discussion Cases (articles available on Blackboard):

Journalism, Health Care, Day Care, Energy Company, Transportation, Education

DUE: Step 2 – Mission and Program Theory.

Class 05 (Feb 18) – Social Entrepreneurship / Social Innovation

Yunus, M. (2011). Building social business: The new kind of capitalism that serves humanity's most pressing needs. CH 1 – Building Social Business.

Where Do Good Ideas Come From?: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NugRZGDbPFU>

Supplementary Readings:

Case 1: Rural electricity.

Case 2: Health care in Brazil.

Case 3: Danone Yogurt.

Case 4: College Access.

Case 5: Robin Hood Foundation.

Student Presentations on Social Entrepreneurship Case Studies.

Class 06 (Feb 25) – Nonprofit Revenues

Anheier, H. K. (2014). Nonprofit organizations: Theory, management, policy. Routledge. CH13 – Financing Nonprofits.

Searing, E. (2013). Feeding the Social Enterprise Zoo. EMES-SOCENT Conference Selected Papers, no. LG13-48.

Supplementary Readings:

Foster, W. L., Kim, P., & Christiansen, B. (2009). Ten nonprofit funding models. Stanford Social Innovation Review, 7(2), 32-39.

Pratt, J. (2005). Analyzing the Dynamics of Funding: Reliability and Autonomy. Strange Accounts: Understanding Nonprofit Finance, Compiled articles from The Nonprofit Quarterly, 19-25.

Belinsky, M. (2012). Social Impact Bonds: Lessons from the Field. Stanford Social Innovation Review.

The Grantmaking Formula for the New Normal. Nonprofit Quarterly, March 2013.

Nonprofits Like the Idea of a State Bond Pool:

<http://www.hartfordbusiness.com/article/20130204/PRINTEDITION/301319956/nonprofits-like-idea-of-state-bond-pool>

Training: Using the Foundation Center Database.

Class 07 (Mar 3) – Enterprising Nonprofits

Foster, W., & Fine, G. (2007). How nonprofits get really big. *Stanford Social Innovation Review*, 5(2), 46-55.

Phills, J. A., & Chang, V. (2005). The Price of Commercial Success Minnesota Public Radio: Social Purpose Capitalism. *Stanford Social Innovation Review*, 3(1), 65-72.

Kaplan, R. S., & Grossman, A. S. (2010). The emerging capital market for nonprofits. *Harvard business review*, 88(10), 110-118.

Supplementary Readings:

The Way We Think About Fundraising is Wrong:

http://www.ted.com/talks/dan_pallotta_the_way_we_think_about_charity_is_dead_wrong?language=en

The Social Innovation Fund: <http://www.whitehouse.gov/administration/eop/sicp/initiatives/social-innovation-fund>

Rosenburg, T. “Putting Charities to the Test.” *The New York Times*: December 5, 2012.

The Case for Letting Nonprofits Run Public Transit: <http://www.citylab.com/commute/2013/08/case-letting-nonprofits-run-public-transit/6563/>

Guest speaker on fundraising strategies.

Class 08 (Mar 10) – Strategic Planning

Bryson, J.M. (2004). Chapter Two: “The Strategy Change Cycle: An Effective Strategic Planning Approach for Public and Nonprofit Organizations.” *Strategic Planning for Public and Nonprofit Organizations*. Jossey-Bass Publishers, San Francisco: CA.

David Cook and Lauren Guzauskas (2012). *Leading IslandWood*. E-PARCC Case Study in Collaborative Governance.

DUE: Step 3: Your Nonprofit’s Resource Strategy.

--- March 17 – Spring Break ---

Class 09 (Mar 24) – Governance and Accountability

Managing for Excellence: Your Checklist for Giving. The Greater Atlanta Community Foundation.

Greenlee, J., Fishcer, M., Gordon, T., & Keating, E. (2007). How to Steal from a Nonprofit: Who Does It and How to Prevent It. *The Nonprofit Quarterly*, Winter.

Pakroo, P. (2009). Starting & building a nonprofit: a practical guide. Nolo. CH4 & CH7.

Supplementary Readings:

Charity Watch Hall of Shame.

Best Practices: Nonprofit Corporate Governance.

Anheier, H. K. (2014). Nonprofit organizations: Theory, management, policy. Routledge. CH15 – Governance, Accountability and Transparency.

Herman, R. D., & Renz, D. O. (2000). Board practices of especially effective and less effective local nonprofit organizations. *The American Review of Public Administration*, 30(2), 146-160.

Guest speaker on running a managing your board.

Class 10 (Mar 31) – Nonprofit Life-Cycles

Lecy, J. & Searing, E. (2016). Changes Over the Life Cycles of Social Enterprises. In *The Social Enterprise Zoo: A Guide to Perplexed Scholars, Entrepreneurs, Philanthropists, Leaders, Investors and Policymakers*, Edward Elgar Publishing.

Hagar, M. & Searing, E. (2015). Ten Ways to Kill Your Nonprofit. *The Nonprofit Quarterly*.

Flynn, D. & Tian, E. (2015). The Death of Hull House. *The Nonprofit Quarterly*.

What's Next for Architects for Humanity? Fast Company, January 22, 2015.

DUE: Step 4 – Analysis of Your Nonprofit's Governance Structure.

Class 11 (Apr 7) – Foundation Sector

Frumkin, P. (1998). The Long Recoil from Regulation Private Philanthropic Foundations and the Tax Reform Act of 1969. *The American Review of Public Administration*, 28(3), 266-286.

Case Studies:

Fleishman, J. (2009). The foundation: A great American secret; how private wealth is changing the world. *PublicAffairs*. CH1, CH7, CH8.

Supplementary Readings:

Sansing, R., & Yetman, R. (2006). Governing private foundations using the tax law. *Journal of Accounting and Economics*, 41(3), 363-384.

Behind Grassroots School Advocacy: Bill Gates. *The New York Times*.

Why Program Related Investments are Not Risky Business – *Forbes*.

The Future of Impact Investing.

Student Presentations on Fleishman Chapters

DUE: 1st Draft of Grant Letter of Intent

Class 12 (Apr 14) – Advocacy and Lobbying

Berry, J. M. (2003). A voice for nonprofits. *Brookings Institution Press*. CH3.

Skocpol, T. (2013). Diminished democracy: From membership to management in American civic life (Vol. 8). *University of Oklahoma press*. CH5.

Supplementary Readings:

Salamon, L.M. & Flaherty, S. (1997). *The Global Dimensions of Nonprofit Law*.

Salamon, L. M. (Ed.). (2012). *The state of nonprofit America*. *Brookings Institution Press*. CH9 – Advocacy.

Moral, “The Revolution Will Not Be Funded.”

DUE: Foundation Profiles

Class 13 (Apr 21) – The Economics of the Arts & Environmental Sectors

Noonan, D. S. (2013). How US Cultural Districts Reshape Neighborhoods. *Cultural Trends*, 22(3-4), 203-212.

Woronkowicz, J., Joyner, D. C., & Bradburn, N. (2014). *Building Better Arts Facilities: Lessons from a US National Study*. Routledge. CH1 and CH6.

Conservation Banks: FAQs.

Supplementary Readings:

Woronkowicz, J. (2013). The determinants of cultural building: Identifying the demographic and economic factors associated with cultural facility investment in US metropolitan statistical areas between 1994 and 2008. *Cultural Trends*, 22(3-4), 192-202.

Straughan, B. (2008). *The broader movement: Nonprofit environmental and conservation organizations, 1989-2005*.

Florida: Rise of the Creative Class: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iLstkIZ5t8g>

DUE: Peer Evaluation of Grants

Class 14 (Apr 28) – Take Home Exam

--- Class 15 (TBD) – Final Presentations ---

DUE: Final Copy of Grant

Course Policies

Academic Integrity and Plagiarism

Syracuse University takes academic integrity very seriously. If you are unfamiliar with the policies they can be found at: http://supolicies.syr.edu/ethics/acad_integrity.htm

Plagiarism will result in an “F” for the course and students may be sent before the academic integrity board. In short, it is not worth it.

Disability Statement

If you believe that you need accommodations for a disability, please contact the Office of Disability Services (ODS), <http://disabilityservices.syr.edu>, located in Room 309 of 804 University Avenue, or call (315) 443-4498 for an appointment to discuss your needs and the process for requesting accommodations. ODS is responsible for coordinating disability-related accommodations and will issue students with documented disabilities Accommodation Authorization Letters, as appropriate. Since accommodations may require early planning and generally are not provided retroactively, please contact ODS as soon as possible.

Syracuse University and I are committed to your success and to supporting Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973. This means that in general no individual who is otherwise qualified shall be excluded from participation in, be denied benefits of, or be subjected to discrimination under any program or activity, solely by reason of having a disability.

You are also welcome to contact me privately to discuss your academic needs. Although I cannot arrange for disability-related accommodations myself, I will help you work with the Office of Disability Services at Syracuse University to support your needs. Please contact the ODS by email in advance: odssched@syr.edu

Attendance

Attendance in the course is required but is not taken and there is no grade assigned for attendance. Lack of attendance, however, can affect your final grade.

Computers and Mobile Devices in Class

The policy is to be determined by the class on the first day.

Classroom Etiquette

Treat each other with respect. Act in a way that creates an intellectually curious environment. Honor intellectual integrity of your classmates, but also be sensitive to views and opinions that are offensive. Minimize disruptions in class, especially tardiness, talking, eating, and text messaging. I tend to enforce the spirit of the law, not the letter.

Office Hours

Office hours are by appointment, but very flexible. If you have questions, please set up a time to meet.